

MS-DOS mode and change to the Windows folder,

```
C:\>cd windows
```

```
C:\windows>
```

Type the following commands and press [Enter] after each one. Note that the extension is .da0 and is the number zero.

```
attrib -h -r -s system.dat
```

```
attrib -h -r -s system.da0
```

```
copy system.da0 system.dat
```

```
attrib -h -r -s user.dat
```

```
attrib -h -r -s user.da0
```

```
copy user.da0 user.dat
```

Now restart your computer. This will restore your registry to when you last successfully started your computer.

Windows 98 has an additional means of backing up the registry. This is done by using the **scanreg** command. This command is not available in Windows 95 and NT. Here is what you do:

Restart in MS-DOS mode and run the **scanreg** command by typing **scanreg /backup** at the command prompt.

The registry will be backed up and will return to DOS prompt. If you need to restore the registry, you have to type the following command in DOS prompt.

```
scanreg /restore
```

Scanreg will check your registry and display the list of available backups. Select the backup at the top of your list. This is the backup you made earlier. Press [R] to restore the backup. When the restoration is complete, type **win** and press [Enter] to start Windows.

These methods will not work for Windows NT/2000. Windows NT/2000 has additional security protection that prevents this backup from being restored.

Windows NT provides many ways to backup the registry, one of them being the **rdisk** utility. Go to **Start > Run** and type **rdisk /s**. Click OK and the Saving Configuration window appears. When this is completed, the setup window opens. Click Yes to create an Emergency Repair Disk (ERD). When you have finished following the onscreen prompts, label the disk 'Emergency Repair Disk' and include the current date. Keep this disk along with the three NT setup disks. These will come in handy (the setup disks and the ERD) if Windows NT becomes unbootable.

If you want to restore the registry to its previous state, boot with the first disk of the three Windows NT setup disks. When the computer has booted, click Repair and choose Registry. You will have a choice of which parts of the registry to restore.

In Windows 2000, go to **Start > Pro-**

Driver Troubles?

Drivers essentially translate commands back and forth between the hardware in question and the operating system, thereby allowing different components of your computer system to work together.

If you haven't installed the right drivers for the right operating system, your hardware will fail to function optimally.

■ For the most part, you will need only the motherboard chipset and graphics card drivers for your system's basic functionality.

■ Additional CI device or peripheral components will require additional drivers.

■ Remember to install service packs and OS level patches before you install any drivers.

■ All drivers are always available on the manufacturer's Web site.

■ This is important. If the current drivers are giving you optimum performance and stability, do not change them. Newer drivers will always promise better performance but can also have bugs.

■ Always unzip and maintain all the drivers you require for your system in one specific folder. If possible, write them onto a CD-RW which you can keep updating.

Installing and updating drivers

If you plan to install a new device or component then the OS will detect the new device and will prompt for suitable drivers. If the OS fails to show you the newly installed device, you need to manually check the device manager for its presence. If the device manager also does not show any sign of new hardware (with an exclamation mark) then it means that

the new device is either not powered on or is not properly seated in the PCI slot.

Usually, the driver that is shipped with the hardware/peripheral is the one that is most reliable. All revisions thereon are just basically fine tuning the core for better performance or stability. Unfortunately, performance is always given priority, sometimes at the cost of stability.

■ Make sure you have successfully downloaded and unzipped (without CRC errors) the new drivers into a temporary directory.

■ If you are upgrading from an older driver, make sure you still have a copy of the old drivers in case something goes wrong.

■ Make a back up of your key Windows system files and registry settings.

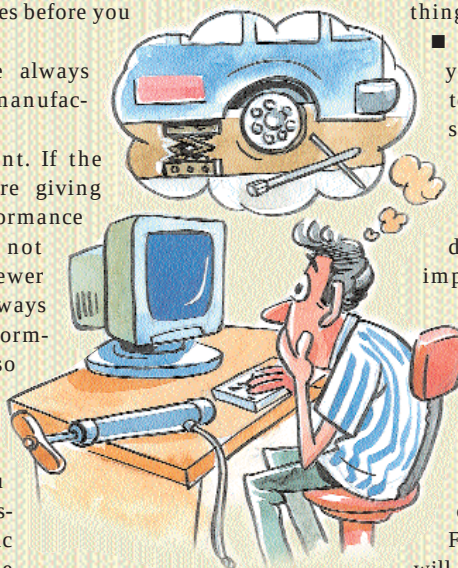
■ Read the readme.txt before you install the new drivers. It is very important to go through the readme.txt for a potential heads up on problems that the manufacturer foresees or otherwise.

■ Remove all traces of the older driver. For most drivers you will have an entry in the

Add/Remove Programs in the Control Panel. Once you've uninstalled the driver, remove all remaining traces by deleting residue directories.

■ You can now point Windows to the right folder containing the driver and proceed with the installation.

■ For manual upgrades, you will have to go to **Start > Settings > Control Panel > System > Device Manager**, select Properties for the specific component, and click on update driver. Windows will then lead you through the process.



grams > Accessories > System Tools > Backup. Click on Tool and then on Create an Emergency Repair Disk. When prompted, insert a disk into the floppy drive and click OK. Label this as 'Emergency Repair Disk'.

To restore settings from the ERD, you will need your Windows 2000 CD, the

Windows 2000 setup disks, and the ERD. During the restoration process, you can press [F1] for more information about your options. Using the ERD will restore your settings to the time Windows was first installed. Using the setup disks will restore the settings to the last time you updated the setup disks. ■